

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: The central problem: conquest without consolidation

BABUR'S VICTORIES -> a core, prestige and a dynastic claim

HUMAYUN'S INHERITANCE -> weak finance + thin administration + rival elites

COMPETING FIELDS -> Afghans in the east + Gujarat-Malwa + Rajput powers

IMPERIAL AMBITION -> Delhi, Gujarat and Bengal pursued before deep rooting

RESULT -> military reach repeatedly outruns revenue, routes and noble commitment

VERDICT: Humayun's fall joins structural weakness to avoidable choices.

MUST REMEMBER: Humayun's Gujarat, Afghan and Rajput theatres form one struggle for empire rather than isolated anecdotes.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Humayun chronology 1530-1556

30 Dec 1530 -> accession | 1533-34 -> Din Panah
1535 -> Mandu, Champaner and Gujarat campaign successes
1537-38 -> six-month Chunar siege and eastern advance
1538-39 -> Gaur occupation and communications crisis
26 Jun 1539 -> Chausa | 17 May 1540 -> Kannauj/Bilgram
1545 -> Qandahar and Kabul recovered | 1555 Delhi | 1556 death.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Inherited balance sheet

ASSET -> Delhi-Agra core, Timurid prestige and campaign capability
FINANCE -> stretched treasury and large assignments to begs
ADMINISTRATION -> conquest not converted into routine territorial control
EAST -> Afghan chiefs and Sher Khan retain regional depth
WEST -> Bahadur Shah links Gujarat, Malwa and Rajasthan
DYNASTY -> princely-share expectations complicate unified sovereignty.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: Brothers: chronology before blame

KAMRAN -> Kabul/Qandahar, then Lahore-Multan and the Punjab hinge

EARLY PHASE -> khutba and sikka remain in Humayun's name

ASKARI -> Gujarat command becomes an administrative cohesion test

HINDAL -> Agra move matters during the stretched Bengal campaign

AFTER CHAUSA -> Kamran withholds hardened troops from Humayun

RULE: fraternal politics changes by time and theatre; avoid timeless guilt.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Rajput-Gujarat-Mughal western triangle

GUJARAT-MALWA -> Bahadur Shah's wealth, artillery and regional expansion

MEWAR / CHITTOR -> Rajput power inside the western strategic field

DELHI-AGRA -> Mughal core threatened through eastern Rajasthan and Malwa

HUMAYUN -> supply pressure at Mandsor, then Mandu and Champaner

KARNAVATI STORY -> later memory; contemporary corroboration is absent

TRAP: Rajputs were not one permanent bloc and legend is not event proof.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Gujarat: victory without settlement

CAMPAIGN -> Mandsor pressure -> Mandu -> Champaner -> Ahmedabad

MILITARY RESULT -> real operational success and territorial seizure

ADMINISTRATIVE GAP -> thin revenue, weak local coalition and divided command

NOBLE PROBLEM -> many begs resist durable residence far from Delhi-Agra

REGIONAL RESPONSE -> Bahadur Shah returns; Askari withdraws; Malwa is lost

LESSON: winning forts is not the same as building a provincial regime.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Sher Khan's Bihar-Bengal scale-up

BIHAR BASE -> forts, revenue, Afghan networks and local knowledge
SURAJGARH 1534 -> Bengal checked and Sher Khan's standing enlarged
GAUR 1537-38 -> Bengal resources and strategic depth enter the contest
HUMAYUN AT CHUNAR -> six months spent before the Bengal advance
SHER KHAN MOVES WEST -> route nodes and communications threatened
OUTCOME: a regional Afghan project becomes an imperial alternative.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Chunar-Gaur communications trap

AGRA-DELHI CORE -> eastern movement depends on a long communication line
CHUNAR -> gateway fort affects land-river movement, supply and rear security
GAUR -> symbolic Bengal occupation but no durable administrative bridge
MONSOON + DISTANCE + NOBLE STRAIN -> Mughal position becomes brittle
SHER KHAN -> controls crossings and pressures the route back west
FORMULA: ambition + delayed logistics + severed communications = isolation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Chausa and Kannauj: do not collapse the battles

CHAUSA, 26 JUN 1539 -> river at Humayun's rear + surprise + near escape

EFFECT -> army shattered, confidence falls, but the contest is not yet closed

KANNAUJ, 17 MAY 1540 -> set battle against a stronger Afghan position

MUGHAL LIMIT -> hastily assembled force lacks Kamran's hardened troops

EFFECT -> Humayun loses north India and Sher Shah's sovereignty opens

TRAP: Chausa weakens; Kannauj decides the first-reign struggle.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: Exile, Safavid bargain and restoration

1540 DEFEAT -> Sindh and a prolonged search for a viable base

SHAH TAHMASP -> assistance is strategic and politically conditioned

1545 -> Qandahar and Kabul recovery rebuilds a north-western platform

SUR FIELD -> succession conflict and fragmentation after Islam Shah

1555 -> Delhi-Agra recovered through restored capacity and opponent weakness

LIMIT: restoration proves resilience, not that the earlier collapse was trivial.

CLOSE DISTINCTION: Chausa (1539) preceded Kannauj/Bilgram (1540); restoration followed in 1555.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Evidence, rehabilitation and heritage

NIZAMUDDIN AHMAD -> alternate chronology; compression and omissions

ABUL FAZL -> fuller reconstruction; later dynastic framing

MIRZA HAIDER -> critical testimony; one voice cannot explain a reign

KARNAVATI TRADITION -> later memory requiring corroboration

HUMAYUN'S TOMB -> later Akbar-era dynastic memory and conservation evidence

METHOD -> replace caricature with ranked evidence, agency and qualification.

EVIDENCE LIMIT: Defeat cannot be explained only by personality: resources, alliances, Afghan resilience and imperial overstretch matter.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Topic 13 answer spine

OPEN -> Babur left a prestigious but unfinished conquest

STRUCTURE -> finance + brothers + unrooted nobles + competing regional powers

AGENCY -> Gujarat overreach, Bengal logistics and Sher Khan's superior timing

BATTLES -> Chausa operational shock; Kannauj decisive political displacement

RECOVERY -> Safavid-backed base + Sur fragmentation + 1555 return

CLOSE -> Humayun failed seriously, but not through a one-word moral defect.